

Computer Science

WACE written examination—2009 design brief

Stage 2

Time allowed

Reading time before commencing work: ten minutes

Working time for paper: three hours

Permissible items

Standard items: pens, pencils, eraser, correction fluid, ruler, highlighter

Special items: non-programmable calculators and a MATHOMAT and/or Mathaid and/or any system flowchart template

Additional information

Content: 45–55% from Unit 2A and 45–55% from Unit 2B
15–20% from Components
15–20% from Design, development and management
60–70 % from Tools

These weightings apply to the whole exam rather than individual sections.

The examination is presented in a combined question/answer booklet with a separate multiple-choice answer sheet.

Section	Supporting information
Section One Multiple-choice 10–20% of the written exam 20 questions Suggested working time: 25 minutes	Stimulus material may include diagrams, tables, algorithm segments and screen captures of databases or programs. Candidates indicate their answers on a separate multiple-choice answer sheet.
Section Two Short answer 30–40% of the written exam 15–20 questions Suggested working time: 65 minutes	Stimulus material may include diagrams, short excerpts from newspaper/journal articles, algorithm segments and screen captures of databases or programs. Questions may relate to stimulus material or a scenario and are structured as a range of closed and open questions that increase in complexity.
Section Three Extended answer 40–55% of the written exam 4–6 questions Suggested working time: 90 minutes	Formats may include scaffolded questions with parts that increase in complexity allowing candidates to demonstrate knowledge and skills relating to scenarios, algorithms, database design, diagrams, and tables. Questions relate to stimulus material or a common scenario to provide an holistic approach.